

Official Prize Rules

Eligibility, project, judging, and prize-distribution rules for Jackson Hacks 2026.

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Prize schedule pending. The number, description, and approximate value of each prize will be published here before project submissions open.

1. No purchase required

No purchase or payment is required to enter or win. Applying to and attending Jackson Hacks is free. The project competition is skill-based.

2. Eligibility

Entrants must be accepted Jackson Hacks 2026 participants, currently enrolled in Grade 9, 10, 11, or 12 or an equivalent high-school program, and in compliance with the Terms and Conditions, Code of Conduct, participant waiver, and these Rules.

Organizers, judges, and people directly involved in selecting winners may not compete. A judge must disclose and avoid scoring a team where a personal, school, financial, mentoring, or other relationship could reasonably create a conflict of interest.

3. Teams

A project may be entered by one to four eligible participants. Each participant may compete on only one team unless the Organizers authorize a documented exception before submissions close. Teams are responsible for deciding how a team prize will be shared.

4. Project period and permitted resources

Substantive project work must be created during the Event. Pre-event planning and learning are allowed, but a team may not present a substantially completed pre-existing project as Event work.

Open-source software, libraries, APIs, datasets, templates, hardware owned by participants, and artificial-intelligence tools are allowed when used lawfully. Teams must clearly disclose meaningful third-party and AI assistance to judges and comply with applicable licenses and terms.

5. Submission requirements

A submission must be received through the official Event process by the announced deadline and must include the requested project name, team members, description, demonstration or presentation, and disclosures. Late or incomplete submissions may be declined unless a documented Event-wide technical issue justifies an extension.

6. Originality, rights, and safety

Teams must have the right to use all submitted material. Projects must not contain malware, stolen credentials, unlawfully obtained data, undisclosed personal information, infringing content, or functionality intended to harm people or systems. The Organizers may restrict an unsafe demonstration while still allowing a safe recorded or simulated presentation.

7. Judging

Eligible projects will be judged on published criteria that may include innovation, technical implementation, design, usefulness, and presentation. The Organizers will publish scoring weights, tie-breaking procedures, category eligibility, and any sponsor-specific criteria before project submissions open.

Judges may inspect a demonstration, ask questions, review disclosed tools and resources, and verify eligibility. Judges' decisions are final except for a calculation error, conflict of interest, eligibility problem, or other material procedural issue confirmed by the Organizers.

8. Prize schedule

Before project submissions open, Jackson Hacks will add a Prize Schedule to these Rules stating the number of prizes, description of each prize, approximate retail value and currency, applicable category or region, and any material condition affecting eligibility or the chance of winning.

A general marketing statement such as '5K+ in prizes' does not replace the final Prize Schedule. If the final schedule differs from earlier promotional material, the final schedule published before entry controls and the change will be communicated clearly.

9. Winner verification and delivery

Potential winners must confirm identity, eligibility, team membership, disclosures, and any required guardian authorization. A prize may be forfeited if a potential winner is ineligible, does not respond by a reasonable stated deadline, refuses required verification, or violated the governing rules.

Prizes will be distributed within a reasonable period after verification. Any substitution will have a reasonably comparable value unless circumstances outside the Organizers' control make that impractical and applicable law permits another resolution.

10. Team prizes and taxes

A prize awarded to a team may be delivered to the team collectively or divided as stated in the Prize Schedule. Jackson Hacks is not responsible for private ownership or allocation disputes among team members. Winners are responsible for personal tax or reporting obligations, if any.

11. Disqualification

A participant, team, submission, score, or prize may be disqualified for ineligibility, material misrepresentation, plagiarism, undisclosed pre-existing work, manipulation, conflict-of-interest abuse, harassment, unsafe conduct, security abuse, or violation of the Terms, Code of Conduct, waiver, or these Rules.

12. Changes and contact

The Organizers may make reasonable changes needed to address safety, fairness, technical failures, unavailable prizes, law, or circumstances outside their control. A material change will be communicated and will not be used solely to unfairly remove an already-earned prize.

Questions about prizes or these Rules may be sent to ayjacksonhacks@gmail.com.